Usefulness of Bacteria

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Use of Bacteria

- Microorganisms can be used by humans to produce foods and other useful substances
- The most common type of microorganisms used in biotechnology are **bacteria**
- They are useful because they are **capable of producing complex molecules** (eg. certain bacteria added to milk produce enzymes that turn the milk into yoghurt)
- They are also useful because they **reproduce rapidly**, meaning the amount of chemicals they can produce can also rapidly increase

Help me understand

Usefulness of Bacteria: Extended

- In addition to the benefits of rapid reproduction and the ability to make complex molecules, bacteria have other benefits in biotechnology
  - There are few ethical considerations to growing them in large numbers in the laboratory
  - They possess plasmids

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